

The Word Of The Year 2025 Edition: A Year In A Few Words [B2]

La lingua cambia al ritmo della società: è attraverso le parole che esprimiamo lo stato d'animo dei nostri tempi. Secondo i più importanti dizionari, questi sono i termini dell'anno.



Even if you've never heard the expression before, you've likely [come across](#) 'rage [bait](#)' online. This is the word that, according to the Oxford English Dictionary, captures last year's zeitgeist, or "the general mood or quality" of this particular period of history, "as shown by the ideas and beliefs common at the time."

GRRRRR!

So what is 'rage [bait](#)'? 'Rage' means intense anger, and 'bait' is something used to attract [prey](#). If you want to catch a fish, it helps to put a [tasty worm](#) as [bait](#) on your [fishing hook](#). The Oxford English Dictionary defines 'rage [bait](#)' as: "online content deliberately designed to [elicit](#) anger or [outrage](#) by being frustrating, provocative, or offensive, typically posted in order to increase traffic to or engagement with a particular web page or social media content." So, for example, posting sexist, racist or homophobic comments is sure to provoke intense anger for a lot of people. The same is true for [outrageous](#) conspiracy theories, and extreme political discourse. The idea of deliberately trying to make people angry online may seem strange, but for platforms and content creators, it can make a lot of sense. Posting [enraging](#) material online as rage [bait](#) attracts users and keeps us engaged; that is, [hooked](#), like that fish tempted by a worm. And the [currency](#) of social media is engagement. Engagement equals [earnings](#). So, platforms like X and Facebook and content creators online need users to stay [hooked](#) — clicking, liking, responding, and sharing more of their content and for longer.

REFLECTING TRENDS

By choosing 'rage [bait](#)', it's the second year running that the Oxford English Dictionary Word of the Year has reflected a negative aspect of our online experience. In 2024, their word of the year was 'brainrot', a noun describing what happens to our brains when we consume too much material (particularly online content) considered to be trivial or [unchallenging](#). In recent years there has also been a trend towards words of the year connected with personal image, especially online: 'rizz' (2023), and 'goblin mode' (2022). Language

Adding New Words to English Approfondisci la storia dell'Oxford English Dictionary con la responsabile della redazione Fiona McPherson, che ci svela l'intricata interazione tra tradizione ed evoluzione tecnologica. Sarah Presant Collins, Sarah Davison

THE SHORTLIST

This year, expert lexicographers at the Oxford English Dictionary compiled a [shortlist](#) of three potential words of the year and asked the public to vote on them. The [shortlist](#) was based on analysis of online data showing how frequently

different words were used in 2025 and how much their usage has increased since 2024. In the case of ‘rage [bait](#)’, use has more than tripled in 2025. Now let’s take a look at the two [runners-up](#) on this year’s [shortlist](#). They are ‘aura farming’ and ‘biohack’. ‘Aura farming’ means “the cultivation of an impressive, attractive, or charismatic persona of public image by behaving or presenting oneself in a way intended subtly to [convey](#) an air of confidence, coolness, or mystique.” Anyone older than fifteen probably doesn’t fully understand what ‘aura farming’ means as it’s mainly used by members of the Generation Alpha (those born since approximately 2010.) The most iconic recent example of someone aura farming is captured in a video of eleven-year-old Rayyan Arkan Dikha from Indonesia. Dikha appears wearing sunglasses and performing cool dance moves while standing on the [bow](#) of a [speeding rowing boat](#). The video went viral and his dance moves have become a meme. Trying to live longer and better is what most of us aspire to. If you make changes to your diet, exercise routine, or lifestyle to try to achieve this, then you are ‘biohacking’. Attempts to [beat aging](#) and “improve or optimise one’s physical or mental performance, health, longevity, or [wellbeing](#)” may involve taking drugs and supplements, using technological [devices](#), or even modifying the body using implants such as chips or genetic manipulation. Some people, especially the super rich, take their biohacking to extremes, believing that, if they get it right, they may even be able to live forever.

MORE WORDS

Other dictionaries have also been publishing their words of the year. Cambridge Dictionary chose ‘parasocial’ for 2025, defining the term as a relationship felt by someone between themselves and a famous person they do not know. This could be a celebrity like Taylor Swift or a character from a TV show or, [weirdest of all](#), an artificial intelligence. Meanwhile, Collins Dictionary went for ‘[vibe coding](#)’, which is the art of making an app or website by describing it to artificial intelligence rather than by writing programming code manually. Just because a word is popular enough to be chosen as a word of the year doesn’t automatically mean that it will be included in the Oxford English Dictionary, though. A word is usually placed on a watch list for several years while lexicographers [gather](#) enough data to be sure the word continues to be widely used. We don’t yet know if ‘rage [bait](#)’ will keep us [hooked](#) long enough to win it a place in the dictionary. <https://corp.oup.com/word-of-the-year> (noun) online content deliberately designed to [elicit](#) anger or [outrage](#) by being frustrating, provocative, or offensive, typically posted in order to increase traffic to or engagement with a particular web page or social media account. Oxford English Dictionary (adjective) involving or relating to a connection that someone feels between themselves and a famous person they do not know, a character in a book, film, TV series, etc., or an artificial intelligence. Cambridge Dictionary (noun) digital content of low quality that is produced usually in quantity by means of artificial intelligence. Merriam-Webster (noun) the use of artificial intelligence [prompted](#) by natural language to assist

with the writing of computer code. Collins (interjection) used to indicate [swagger](#) or [insider](#) status in internet and youth culture. Dictionary.com (noun) low-quality content created by generative AI, often containing errors, and not requested by the user. Macquarie Dictionary

Glossary

- **prey** = preda
- **goblin** = folletto
- **weirdest of all** = la cosa più strana di tutte
- **currency** = moneta, valuta
- **brainrot** = marciume mentale
- **aging** = invecchiamento
- **slop** = spazzatura, brodaglia
- **insider** = esperto
- **hooked** = agganciare
- **earnings** = profitti, guadagni
- **unchallenging** = poco impegnativo, semplice
- **runners-up** = finalisti
- **gather** = raccogliere
- **prompted** = suggerire, stimolare
- **come across** = imbattersi in
- **tasty worm** = verme gustoso
- **fishing hook** = amo da pesca
- **elicit** = provocare
- **rizz** = fascino, carisma
- **convey** = trasmettere
- **speeding** = sfrecciare
- **rowing boat** = barca a remi
- **bait** = esca, trappola
- **beat** = sconfiggere
- **vibe coding** = programmare a sensazione
- **Rage** = ira
- **shortlist** = preselezione
- **bow** = prua
- **devices** = dispositivi
- **outrage** = indignazione
- **wellbeing** = benessere
- **swagger** = disinvoltura